# ENG-0007: Incident Postmortem for INC-106

## Impact

The incident identified as INC-106, reported on January 3, 2025, involved the auth-api system (System ID: SYS-002), which is a critical component within Project Titan. The auth-api system, managed under the ownership of Project Titan, experienced a Sev1 severity level disruption lasting approximately 1.5 hours. This outage impacted authentication services, potentially affecting user access and operational workflows across dependent systems. The incident was promptly escalated and addressed, minimizing overall disruption to a brief duration.

## Timeline

- **January 3, 2025**: The incident was reported by Angie Henderson, Head of Human Resources, at approximately [exact time not specified]. The auth-api system experienced a failure attributed to a configuration change.
- **Immediate Response**: Cameron Parker, the on-call engineer for auth-api, was alerted and initiated troubleshooting procedures.
- **Resolution**: The root cause was identified as a configuration change that was not properly validated before deployment. The issue was rectified within 1.5 hours, restoring normal service.
- **Post-Resolution**: Monitoring confirmed system stability, and incident closure was documented shortly thereafter.

## Root Cause

The root cause of the incident was classified under the category of "config_change." Specifically, an unvalidated configuration change was implemented in the auth-api system, which is built on a Python/Django/MySQL tech stack. The change led to system instability, resulting in the Sev1 incident. This change was not subjected to the appropriate change management procedures, leading to the failure.

## Action Items

| Action Item | Responsible Party | Due Date | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Review and reinforce change management procedures for all configuration changes | Project Titan Lead (E-097) | Immediate | Ensure all future changes undergo validation and approval processes. |
| Conduct a post-incident review of the recent configuration change process | Project Titan Team | Within one week | Identify gaps and implement improvements to prevent recurrence. |
| | DevOps Team | Within two weeks | |

| Action Item | Responsible Party | Due Date | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Implement additional monitoring and alerting for auth-api configuration changes | | | Enable quicker detection of unauthorized or unvalidated changes. |
| Re-train staff involved in configuration management and change deployment | HR and Project Titan Training Coordinators | Within one month | Promote adherence to established protocols and reduce human error. |
| Document lessons learned and update incident response procedures accordingly | Incident Response Team | Within two weeks | Improve response times and resolution strategies for similar incidents. |

## Conclusion

The incident involving auth-api (INC-106) was caused by a configuration change that bypassed standard validation procedures. The swift response by Cameron Parker minimized downtime to 1.5 hours. Moving forward, enhanced change management, monitoring, and staff training are prioritized to mitigate the risk of similar incidents. Continuous improvement in these areas will support the ongoing stability and reliability of Project Titan's critical systems.